Transport Planning, Development & Streetworks Management
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Transport Development Management

Memo

To: Planning Services
From: Transport Development Management
Date: 14th October 2025

Application Number: S/COND/25/1184

Proposal: Partial Discharge of Condition 9 - Character Area Design Code from previous application S/OUT/13/1555 - Outline Planning Permission, for a sustainable urban extension to the east of Swindon and north of the A420 of up to 2,380 dwellings together with a mixed use local centres/areas (including A1 retail up to 1,500 sq metres, services (A2), restaurants, pubs and takeaways (A3, A4, A5), business uses (B1) up to 1,000 sq metres, residential); community uses (D1); sheltered and/or care accommodation (C2/C3); two primary schools; green infrastructure including formal (including playing fields) and informal open space, landscape, biodiversity and amenity space; play space (including NEAPS/LEAPS/MUGAS); changing and sports facilities (including D2) and ancillary retail uses; sustainable drainage systems; highway, cycle and pedestrian routes; car parking; infrastructure (including utilities); engineering works including ground remodelling; demolition, site reclamation and removal of structures; the formation of new accesses from the A420, Old Vicarage Lane and Thornhill Road.

Location: Land North Of A420 Eastern Villages

Thank you for inviting Highways & Transport comment on the above application to discharge a Planning Conditions from Outline Planning Permission S/OUT/13/1555.

<u>Condition 9 – Character Area Design Code</u>
A Design Code relating to each Character Area as defined in the Strategic Design Code, shall be submitted to, and be approved in writing by the Local Planning Authority prior to the submission of the first reserved matters application within that Character Area. Each Design Code shall be in accordance with the Strategic Design Code approved pursuant to condition 8 above and shall include detailed guidance for that specific Character Area in respect of:
a) The overall vision and character of the character area, and mix of uses;
b) How the character and identity of the development parcel will be established and strengthened through consideration of the public realm, streets, green infrastructure, retained and proposed planting, open spaces and play areas;
c) The form of the development, with reference to densities, block types, building types, building heights, the palette of materials, recycling and waste management, street furniture, inclusive design;
d) The sequencing, hierarchy, typology, and treatments of all elements of the movement network (including a proposed route to the eastern boundary to facilitate a highway link into Nightingale Wood within the appropriate Character Area Code);
e) Principles of traffic management, parking provision (including for the 5no. 'car share scheme parking spaces' across the site) and servicing to all properties;

f) The form of movement connections from within housing parcels to connect to the wider pedestrian/cycle network identified on 'Indicative Access and Movement Plan' (LHL005/162 rev P) that provide connectivity to facilities and services; and
g) Any alterations to public transport routes to accommodate the defined phases of development within the site.
Each reserved matters application shall be accompanied by a checklist to demonstrate where the development accords with the relevant approved Character Area Design Code.

The application form indicates that this is a part discharge of condition and relates to the Character Area Design Code (CADC) 4 – Nightingale Edge.

Section 3: Regulating Plan

I am content that the Character Area Regulating Plan shown on Page 23 is consistent with the Strategic Coding Plan within the Strategic Design Code (SDC).

Section 4: Movement and Access

Details of the proposed movement sequencing is shown on Page 28. In principle, the proposed sequencing appears reasonable; however, reference should be made to whether the sequencing aligns with the planning obligations set out in the Section 106.

Primary Street –

- Page 30 – reference is made to two typical street sections, but only one Secondary Street typology is shown and detailed on page 31. Nonetheless, all street typologies will be required to accord with the SDC.
- Page 30 – reference is made to permeable paving. It should be noted that SBC will not adopt this.

Tertiary Street -

- Page 32 – I am content that the Tertiary Street characteristics align with those set out in the SDC. I note that any need for localised widening will be identified and addressed at the reserved matters stage.

Vehicle Parking –

- I am content that the information contained on pages 34 and 35 is appropriate and consistent with the SDC and CADCs 1-3. I note that the location of parallel parking bays will be agreed at the reserved matters stage, as will the location of parking courts.

Walking and Cycling Movement –

- I am satisfied that the coding instruction is consistent with the SDC.
- Three 'key pedestrian and cyclist crossing points' are illustrated on the Walking and Cycling Movement Plan on Page 37. Further details of these crossings will be required at the reserved matters stage.
- The location of pedestrian and cyclist crossings will be agreed at the reserved matters stage.
- The cycle parking details on page 38 are acceptable.
- Page 38 refers to the existing bridleway. While the details are consistent with the SDC, the vehicular access arrangements to Rowborough Farm will need to be confirmed/agreed at the RM stage.

Bridleway –

- Vehicular access arrangements to Rowborough Farm will need to be confirmed/agreed at the RM Stage. Additionally, it should be noted that as per the SDC, any new vehicular crossings are required to include safe crossing facilities.

The Public Transport and Shared Mobility section is omitted, presumably because bus stops are located along the Primary Street, which falls outside the scope of this CADC. It is understood that the five designated car share scheme parking spaces will be situated at the Neighbourhood Hub and/or the Sports Hub.

Section 5: Built Form and Identity

Public Realm –

- The information contained in paragraphs 5.11 and 5.12 is consistent with CADCs 1-3. I note that the location of street furniture will be agreed at the reserved matters stage.
- Page 45 refers to root barriers. Details of these root barriers will need to be confirmed and included in future reserved matters applications.
- Planting within sight lines to be agreed with SBC.

Recycling and Waste Management –

- The information contained on page 72 is consistent with CADCs 1 and 2.
- No details are provided regarding interim refuse and recycling arrangements. Where interim arrangements are required, these will be dealt with at the reserved matters stage.

Inclusive Design –

- The information contained on page 73 is consistent with CADCs 1-3.

No highway objection is raised.

Please note that the comments made here represent Officer opinion and cannot be seen to prejudice Swindon Borough Council's formal determination in relation to any application or planning matter.
Kind Regards,
Chelsey

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